

Gaming

Although the cause of much controversy, video games can help players develop and improve key life skills, including collaboration and problem-solving. When people balance the time spent gaming with other activities, gaming can be a fun and beneficial hobby.

Types of games

Tens of thousands of new video games are released every year. Whether they are played on phones, computers, or consoles, most video games can be categorized into six genres: sports, action, puzzles, role-playing, simulation, and strategy. Research shows that each type of game can help individuals to develop and improve different areas of cognitive thinking and abilities that can be applied in the real world. For parents, gaming with their teens can demystify it, enabling them to see for themselves what their teens get out of it.

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“The obvious objective of video games is to entertain people by surprising them with new experiences.”

Shigeru Miyamoto, creator of the “Super Mario” series



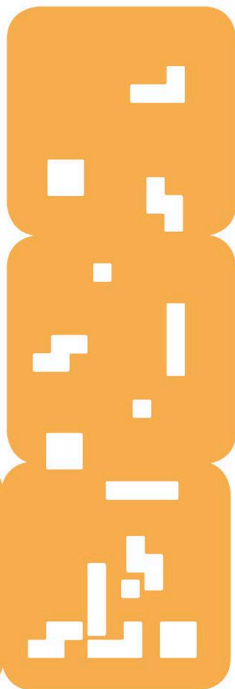
Sports games

Video games of sports mimic the real world in the rules, teams, and players they feature. These games are great for group-play, and can encourage involvement in the sport in the real world, too.



Action games

Often featuring exaggerated and energetic battles, action games test and improve players' hand-eye coordination, spatial awareness, and reaction time—improving a person's speed and ability to learn in general due to the fast-paced action.



Puzzle games

Especially suited to occasional and smartphone players, puzzle games include problem-solving, pattern recognition, and word completion, often using a timer or limited chances.

Role-playing games (RPG)

RPGs allow players to control a character and their story, improving players' problem-solving skills as the characters encounter different challenges. Many RPGs are “open world” games, in which players can freely roam rather than following a strict linear story.

